

Activity 4 - Build the Scope Baseline with WBS and Dictionary

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 2 | Develop a Project Plan
Learning outcome: LO2 Duration: 45 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Work Breakdown Structure, WBS Dictionary and Requirements Traceability Matrix

Objective

Turn approved requirements into a complete, manageable scope baseline (A2, K2).

The situation

The team has 14 prioritised requirements, but the vendor proposal groups work by department and omits outlet readiness, training and handover. Estimates cannot be trusted until the total scope is visible.

What you will do

Create a deliverable-oriented WBS, apply the 100% rule, define work packages in the dictionary and reconcile every requirement and acceptance criterion to scope.

What you will produce

A scope statement, WBS, WBS dictionary and repaired traceability matrix with no missing or duplicated work.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/24 Work Breakdown Structure.pptx`](#)
- [`tools/24 WBS Dictionary.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/25 Requirements Traceability Matrix.xlsx`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Write the scope statement: deliverables, exclusions, assumptions, constraints and acceptance conditions.
2. Decompose by deliverable rather than department; include project management and transition work.
3. Apply the 100% rule and test for overlap between sibling elements.
4. Stop decomposition where a work package can be estimated, assigned, sequenced and accepted.
5. Complete dictionary entries for description, owner, acceptance, dependencies, assumptions and estimate basis.
6. Map each requirement to at least one work package and each work package to a requirement or project-management need.
7. Ask another team to find omitted, duplicated or ambiguous scope and repair the baseline.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

The WBS covers 100% of authorised work without overlap, each work package is manageable and every requirement traces to acceptance-ready scope.

Debrief

- The WBS describes all project work; the schedule describes when that work occurs.
- Transition and project-management work are real scope even when customers never see them.
- A strong dictionary prevents different teams from estimating different meanings.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 4. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.